

ABDOUNE SALIM

Cybersecurity Engineer | DFIR & AI Security Researcher | LLM Red Teamer

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RESEARCH SUMMARY

Cybersecurity engineer and researcher specializing in Digital Forensics & Incident Response (DFIR) and AI Security. Master's thesis deployed at Air Algérie integrates Velociraptor, Elastic Stack, and a RAG-augmented LLM for automated threat hunting — achieving 100% ATT&CK detection and blocking 22/22 adversarial prompts. Research paper currently under review at *Expert Systems with Applications* (Elsevier Q1, IF 7.5). Ranked #29 globally in adversarial AI red-teaming (Gray Swan AI Arena, 74+ confirmed model breaks). Seeking PhD opportunities at the intersection of AI and cybersecurity — with focus on adversarial machine learning, LLM security, and automated threat detection.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree — Computer Science + State Engineering Degree — Computer Science, Cybersecurity Specialization 2021 – 2026

ESTIN (École Supérieure en Sciences et Technologies de l'Informatique et du Numérique) · Béjaia, Algeria

- Double diploma: Diplôme d'Ingénieur d'État (5-year Master's-equivalent) + Master's Degree. Graduated June 2026.
- Final-year thesis: Smart DFIR Platform integrating Velociraptor, Elastic Stack, and RAG-LLM — deployed at Air Algérie
- Co-authored research paper under review at *Expert Systems with Applications* (Elsevier)

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

"Enhancing DFIR Workflows using RAG-Based LLMs with Prompt-Injection Defense" 2026

Expert Systems with Applications · Elsevier (Q1, IF 7.5) — Under Review

Salim Abdoune, Madani Samy Debaili, Nasreddine Abdelli, Samiha Ait Taleb

- End-to-end Velociraptor + Elastic Stack + RAG-LLM DFIR pipeline for automated threat hunting and AI-assisted investigation
- Novel four-stage prompt injection classifier: 22/22 adversarial prompts blocked, 6/6 LLM-bypass attacks intercepted
- 100% ATT&CK detection rate (8/8 techniques) and mean time to detect of 23.5 seconds
- Validated in production deployment at Air Algérie national carrier

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Red Teamer (Contractor)

Feb 2026 – Present

Gray Swan AI · Remote

- Adversarial assessment of production LLM deployments — prompt injection, agentic workflow attacks, orchestrator override, system prompt extraction
- Built reusable attack frameworks generalizing across model families (GPT-4, Claude, Gemini, Llama)
- Ranked #29 globally in the Gray Swan Arena with 74+ confirmed model breaks

Cybersecurity Research Internship — Thesis Deployment

Feb – Jun 2026

Air Algérie · Algiers, Algeria

- Deployed first integrated DFIR platform at Air Algérie: Velociraptor endpoint forensics + Elastic SIEM + RAG-LLM investigation assistant
- Automated threat hunting pipeline achieving 100% ATT&CK detection (8/8 techniques) and 23.5s MTTD
- Implemented and evaluated four-stage prompt-injection defense — blocked all 22 adversarial test prompts and 6 LLM-bypass attacks

Blue Teaming Workshop Instructor

2024 – Present

Nexus Security Club · ESTIN, Béjaia

- Designed and delivered hands-on blue teaming curriculum to 30+ members: threat hunting, malware analysis, reverse engineering, incident response
- Authored original CTF challenges across forensics and exploitation tracks

Network Security Internship

Summer 2023

Algérie Télécom · Algeria

- Network infrastructure monitoring, incident triage, and security configuration review on enterprise-grade environments

Cybersecurity Internship

Summer 2022

ESTIN · Béjaia, Algeria

- Network monitoring, vulnerability assessment fundamentals, and internal infrastructure security review

TECHNICAL SKILLS

DFIR & Forensics: Velociraptor, Elastic Stack (ELK/SIEM), Kibana, Wireshark, Volatility, Autopsy, CyberChef

AI / ML Security: RAG-LLM, Qwen2.5-7B, Prompt Injection Defense, Adversarial ML, LLM Red Teaming, Agentic Security

Threat Detection: MITRE ATT&CK, Sigma Rules, YARA, Suricata, Nmap, Nessus

Programming: Python

Infrastructure: Docker, Linux

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CNSP** — Certified Network Security Practitioner · The SecOps Group · 2025

CERTIFICATES

- **C3SA** — Certified Cyber Security Analyst (Premium Edition) · CyberWarFare Labs · 2025
- **ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor** · Mastermind Assurance · 2025
- **Network Defense** · Cisco Networking Academy / The Open University · 2025
- **Security Operations (SOC) 101** · TCM Security · 2024
- **CCNA v7 — Introduction to Networks** · Cisco Networking Academy · 2024

LANGUAGE

- **English** — B2 (IELTS 6.0)